

NIDAL ENGLISH

Handling a Problem at the Airport

Portfolio Demonstration Lesson · B1 Functional English · Speaking

A complete lesson pack containing the lesson plan, worksheet, airport problem cards, language bank, presentation outline, teaching demonstration notes and reflection.

45-minute lesson · Adult English Learners · 1–6 learners (adaptable)

Lesson Details

Category	Details
Category	Functional English / Speaking
Level	B1 – Intermediate
Learners	Adult English Learners
Number of Learners	1–6 (adaptable for larger classes)
Lesson Length	45 minutes
Main Skill	Speaking
Supporting Skills	Listening, Functional Vocabulary
Topic	Handling a Passenger Problem at an Airport
Context	A passenger approaches an airport staff member because something has gone wrong.
Teaching Approach	Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) using a Presentation–Practice–Production (PPP) framework
Language Focus	Asking for information, clarifying, reassuring, offering help and explaining solutions

Lesson Aim

To develop learners' ability to communicate politely and effectively when helping someone who has an airport-related problem.

Learning Objectives

- Recognise and understand useful expressions used when assisting passengers.
- Use polite functional English to ask questions, clarify information, reassure passengers and offer assistance.
- Participate in a realistic airport role-play using appropriate language.

Success Criteria

By the end of the lesson learners should be able to successfully respond to situations such as:

Passenger: Excuse me, I think I've lost my boarding pass.

Staff: I'm sorry to hear that. How can I help you?

Passenger: I don't know what to do.

Staff: Don't worry. Let me check that for you.

The objective is not to memorise a script but to communicate naturally.

Target Language

Offering Help

- How can I help you?

Clarifying

- Could you explain what happened?

Checking Information

- Do you mean that your flight has been cancelled?

Reassuring

- Don't worry.
- I'll see what I can do.

Offering Assistance

- Let me check that for you.

Giving Instructions Politely

- Could you please wait here for a moment?

Optional Extension

- Is there anything else I can help you with?

Anticipated Problems & Solutions

Problem 1

Problem: Students may understand the language but struggle to produce it spontaneously.

Solution: Provide controlled practice before role-play and allow learners to use a small language bank.

Problem 2

Problem: Students may use direct language, e.g. "Wait here." instead of "Could you please wait here for a moment?"

Solution: Compare both versions and discuss which is more appropriate in customer-service situations.

Problem 3

Problem: Students may focus too much on grammar instead of communication.

Solution: Allow fluency during speaking tasks and provide delayed correction afterwards.

Materials

- Airport picture
- Presentation slides
- Language bank
- Controlled practice worksheet
- Airport problem cards
- Teacher answer key
- Whiteboard or tablet
- Markers (or digital pen)

Interaction Key

Symbol	Meaning
T → Ss	Teacher speaks or gives instructions to the whole class.
T ↔ Ss	Teacher and students interact together.
S ↔ S	Students work or communicate with each other.
Ss → T	Students respond to the teacher.
Individual	Students work independently.
Groups	Students work together in small groups.

Full Lesson Plan

Stage 1 – Warm-up / Context

Time: 5 minutes **Interaction:** T → Ss / T ↔ Ss

Aim: Introduce the lesson topic and activate students' background knowledge about airport situations.

Teacher Activity

- Display an airport picture.
- Ask: "Where are these people?", "What can you see?", and "What problems might passengers have at an airport?"

- Elicit vocabulary: delayed flight, cancelled flight, lost luggage, wrong gate, lost boarding pass.
- Ask: "If someone comes to you with a problem, what could you say first?" Guide students toward "How can I help you?"

Student Activity

- Identify the location
- Discuss airport problems
- Brainstorm vocabulary
- Suggest responses

Materials: Airport picture, Whiteboard or tablet

Stage 2 – Presentation / Elicitation

Time: 8 minutes **Interaction:** T ↔ Ss

Aim: Introduce the target language through guided discovery.

Teacher Activity

- Use realistic airport situations to elicit language before confirming expressions.
- Example: Passenger: "Excuse me. I can't find my boarding pass." Ask: "What could you say?"
- Confirm or introduce the target expressions.

Student Activity

- Listen
- Think
- Suggest answers
- Compare ideas
- Repeat expressions

Materials: Slides, Whiteboard

Stage 3 – Clarification of Meaning, Form & Pronunciation (MFP)

Time: 7 minutes **Interaction:** T ↔ Ss

Aim: Ensure students understand meaning, form and pronunciation.

Teacher Activity

- Use simple CCQs.
- For "Could you explain what happened?" ask whether the staff member already knows the problem (No) and whether they want more information (Yes).
- For "Let me check that for you." ask whether the staff member is offering help (Yes) and whether the passenger solves the problem alone (No).
- Model pronunciation; use choral and individual repetition.

Student Activity

- Answer CCQs
- Identify meaning
- Repeat expressions

- Practise pronunciation

Materials: Whiteboard, Slides

Stage 4 – Controlled Practice

Time: 7 minutes **Interaction:** Individual → S ↔ S → T ↔ Ss

Aim: Practise target language accurately before freer communication.

Teacher Activity

- Distribute the worksheet.
- Students complete it individually.
- Students compare answers in pairs.
- Teacher checks answers with the class.

Student Activity

- Complete worksheet
- Compare answers
- Participate in correction

Materials: Worksheet, Language Bank

Stage 5 – Guided Speaking Practice

Time: 5 minutes **Interaction:** S ↔ S

Aim: Move students from controlled practice to guided communication.

Teacher Activity

- Give each pair one Airport Problem Card.
- Instruct students to use at least three target expressions.
- Monitor and support.
- After approximately three minutes, rotate partners once and repeat with a different classmate.

Student Activity

- Work in pairs
- Role-play passenger and airport staff
- Use at least three expressions
- Rotate partners
- Repeat with a new partner

Materials: Airport Problem Cards, Language Bank

Stage 6 – Freer Role-play

Time: 8 minutes **Interaction:** S ↔ S

Aim: Develop fluency and confidence using the target language.

Teacher Activity

- Provide a new airport situation.

- Students receive no script.
- Monitor discreetly and note useful language, pronunciation and common errors.
- Delay feedback until after the activity.

Student Activity

- Listen carefully
- Clarify the problem
- Reassure the passenger
- Offer a solution
- Communicate naturally

Materials: Airport Problem Cards

Stage 7 – Feedback & Error Correction

Time: 3 minutes **Interaction:** T ↔ Ss

Aim: Reinforce successful language and correct important errors.

Teacher Activity

- Write anonymous examples on the board.
- Highlight effective language.
- Elicit corrections.
- Praise successful communication.
- Begin with positive feedback and guide learners to self-correct where possible.

Student Activity

- Analyse language
- Identify mistakes
- Suggest corrections

Stage 8 – Plenary / Exit Check

Time: 2 minutes **Interaction:** T ↔ Ss

Aim: Confirm that students can use the target language independently.

Teacher Activity

- Present three short airport situations.
- Ask students to respond appropriately.
- Example: Passenger: "I've lost my luggage." Expected response: "How can I help you?"

Student Activity

- Respond without using the Language Bank

Lesson Timing Summary

Stage	Time
Warm-up	5 min
Presentation	8 min
Meaning, Form & Pronunciation	7 min
Controlled Practice	7 min
Guided Speaking	5 min
Freer Role-play	8 min
Feedback	3 min
Plenary	2 min
Total	45 min

Controlled Practice Worksheet

Instructions: Complete the sentences using the expressions in the box.

Useful Expressions

- How can I help you?
- Could you explain what happened?
- Let me check that for you.
- Don't worry. I'll see what I can do.
- Could you please wait here for a moment?

1. Passenger: I can't find my boarding pass.

Airport Staff:

2. Passenger: My luggage hasn't arrived.

Airport Staff: I'm sorry to hear that.

3. Passenger: My flight has been cancelled.

Airport Staff:

4. Passenger: Thank you for your help.

Airport Staff:

5. Airport Staff: I'll speak to my colleague.

Answer Key

- 1. How can I help you?
- 2. Let me check that for you.
- 3. Could you explain what happened?
- 4. Is there anything else I can help you with?
- 5. Could you please wait here for a moment?

Airport Problem Cards

Card 1 – Lost Boarding Pass

You cannot find your boarding pass. Ask the airport staff for help.

Card 2 – Flight Delay

Your flight has been delayed. Ask what you should do next.

Card 3 – Wrong Gate

You are waiting at the wrong gate. Ask for directions.

Card 4 – Missing Luggage

Your suitcase did not arrive. Report the problem politely.

Card 5 – Flight Cancellation

Your flight has been cancelled. Ask what your options are.

Card 6 – Special Assistance

You need help finding the assistance desk. Ask the airport staff for directions.

Language Bank

Greeting

- Good morning.
- Good afternoon.
- Hello.

Offering Help

- How can I help you?
- What seems to be the problem?

Clarifying

- Could you explain what happened?
- Could you repeat that, please?

Reassuring

- I understand.
- Don't worry.
- I'll see what I can do.

Offering Assistance

- Let me check that for you.
- I'll speak to my colleague.

Giving Instructions

- Could you please wait here for a moment?
- Please follow me.

Closing the Conversation

- You're welcome.
- Have a nice day.
- Is there anything else I can help you with?

Presentation Slides

Slide 1 – Title

- Handling a Problem at the Airport
- Lesson title
- Teacher name
- B1 Functional English

Slide 2 – Lead-in

- Airport photograph
- Discussion questions
- “What problems can passengers have?”

Slide 3 – Target Language

- Offering Help
- Clarifying
- Reassuring
- Offering Assistance

Slide 4 – Controlled Practice

- Worksheet instructions
- Example question
- Pair-check reminder

Slide 5 – Airport Role-play

- Role-play instructions
- Airport Problem Cards
- Success criteria

Slide 6 – Lesson Review

- What expressions did we learn?
- Which expression would you use first?
- Exit question

Teaching Demonstration

Part 1 — Interactive Teaching

Duration: Approximately 4–6 minutes.

Purpose: Demonstrate classroom presence, questioning techniques, elicitation and interaction.

What to Include

- Welcome learners.
- Introduce the airport situation.
- Ask questions.

- Elicit target language.
- Use CCQs.
- Model pronunciation.
- Encourage learner participation.

Part 2 — Digital Board Demonstration

Duration: Approximately 3–5 minutes.

Purpose: Demonstrate how you use digital teaching resources.

What to Include

- Write key expressions.
- Highlight important language.
- Correct common mistakes.
- Demonstrate one controlled activity.
- Show one short role-play example.

Reflection

This lesson is designed to maximise student speaking time while providing enough language support for learners to communicate successfully. The progression from controlled activities to freer communication allows students to develop both confidence and fluency in a realistic airport context. Teacher feedback is delayed until after speaking tasks to encourage natural communication while still improving language accuracy. The lesson reflects a communicative and learner-centred teaching philosophy where language is learned through meaningful interaction rather than memorisation.

Teacher Notes

Timing

- If learners finish early: extend the role-play activity; introduce a new airport problem; rotate partners again.
- If learners need more support: keep the Language Bank visible; model one additional dialogue; reduce the number of expressions learners are required to use.

Differentiation

- Higher-level learners can create their own airport situations using the target language.
- Lower-level learners may refer to the Language Bank during speaking activities until they gain confidence.